riage is recognized; also divorce under certain circumstances.

There is a reference to *chinapatta,* silk fabrics of China manufacture, and a distinction is made between these and the silk made in India. Probably the latter was of a coarser variety.

The importation of Chinese silk indicates trade contacts with China at least as early as the fourth century **B.C.**

T h e king, at the time of his coronation, had to take the oath of service to the people—'May I be deprived of heaven, of life, and of offspring if I oppress you.' 'In the happiness of his subjects lies his happiness; in their welfare, whatever pleases himself he shall consider as not good, but whatever pleases his subjects, he shall consider as good.' 'If a king is energetic, his subjects will be equally energetic.' Public work could not suffer or await the king's pleasure; he had always to be ready for it. And if the king misbehaved, his people had the right to remove him and put another in his place.

There was an irrigation department to look after the many canals, and a navigation department for the harbours, ferries, bridges, and the numerous boats and ships that went up and down the rivers and crossed the seas to Burma and beyond.